

The Unofficial Behringer X-Touch Companion

Edition 0.2 – Draft

Chapter 2 – Understanding the X-Touch

Before learning individual buttons, it helps to understand how the X-Touch 'thinks'. Unlike a conventional MIDI controller, it is a hardware representation of Bitwig's current state. The computer remains in charge; the X-Touch reflects and manipulates that state.

2.1 Eight Physical Channels – Unlimited Tracks

One of the first misconceptions is that the X-Touch can only control eight tracks. In reality it controls eight tracks at a time. Think of the surface as an eight-channel window that slides across your project.

The BANK buttons move the window eight tracks at a time. The CHANNEL buttons move it one track at a time. Once this idea clicks, navigation throughout Bitwig becomes much easier.

Why?

Motorised faders move because Bitwig is continuously sending new values to the controller. When you change banks, the faders are not 'remembering' positions—they are immediately being updated to represent the newly selected tracks.

Gotcha!

Many new users think a moving fader indicates a fault. It usually indicates the opposite: communication between Bitwig, DrivenByMoss and the X-Touch is working correctly.

Try it now

Create a project with twelve tracks. Press BANK ► once. Watch the motor faders jump from tracks 1–8 to tracks 9–12. Press BANK ◀ to return. You've just experienced one of the key concepts behind every professional control surface.